

Meet Alex.

Fifteen years in WASH programmes. The funding just collapsed. Years of collected data sit on her desktop.

Alex is a composite, drawn from the practitioners in our two course cohorts. She is not one real person. Her situation is real everywhere.

Our topic: Publishing WASH Data Together, a hands-on retreat for an open, AI-ready sector.

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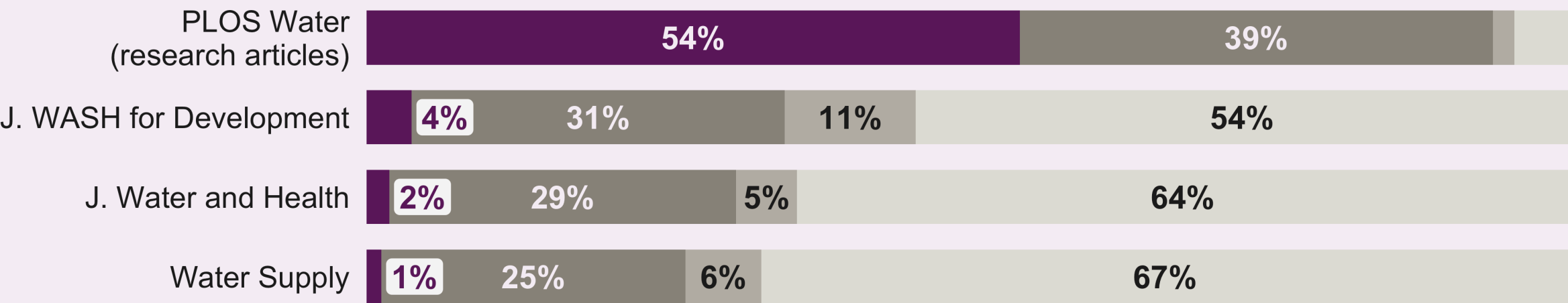
Where is Alex's data supposed to go?

a) Why this topic, why now

Data almost never reaches an open repository, unless the journal asks and supports

Data availability statements by journal, share of 8,403 articles, 2001 to 2026

■ Open repository ■ In paper or supplement ■ On request ■ No statement or other



Data: <https://github.com/openwashdata/washopenresearch> (CC BY 4.0).

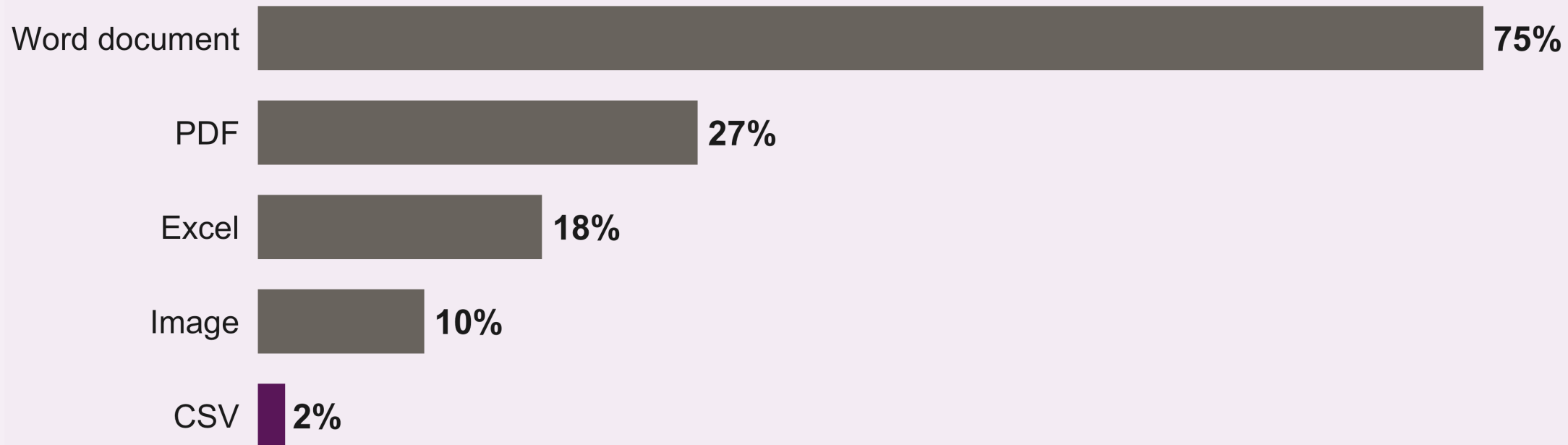
Without a journal that asks and supports: 1 in 57 articles points to data in an open repository.

When files are attached, what are they?

a) Why this topic, why now

The attached "data" is mostly Word and PDF files

Share of the 771 papers with supplementary files; one paper can attach several formats



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Only CSV is machine readable and non proprietary. A CSV without documentation is still closed data.

Why AGUASAN, and why 2027

a) Why as an AGUASAN Workshop

- **The 40th AGUASAN Workshop:** the community of practice, hosted by the SDC, that shapes the WASH sector's practice, and the participants are the people who hold the data
- **The retreat format is the method:** a week of hands-on practical workshops, not a lecture series
- **The funding window closes in 2026:** five ETH Board Open Research Data projects, about CHF 500,000, the 2024 National Prize, 51 published datasets; AGUASAN is the bridge from a funded programme to standing sector practice

Alex signs up: the work starts four weeks early

b) What participants take away

- **Months before the workshop:** the signup form asks for her dataset, screened before acceptance; data is the entry ticket
- **At least four weeks of pre-work with individual support:** accounts, setup, documentation, permissions
- **No coding background required:** designed for novices, and a shared cloud environment gives everyone the same start
- **Qualitative data is welcome:** the FAIRqual project built the experience for the harder cases

What Alex takes home

b) What participants take away

- **A published data package:** documented, openly licensed, citable with a DOI; final draft by Friday, archiving the final step
- **Skills that outlast any WASH job:** Git and GitHub, Quarto (alternative for MS Word), safe and confident work with AI agents
- **A plan:** each participant leaves with concrete next steps for their own organisation

We carry it: before, during, after

c) Who convenes and follows up

Thanks

REFERENCES

- **Data and code:**
github.com/openwashdata/wash-openresearch
- **These slides:** [download as PDF](#)
- **Built with Quarto and reveal.js:**
quarto.org/docs/presentations/revealjs

RESOURCES

- **The openwashdata community:**
openwashdata.org
- **The FAIRqual project:** fairqual.org
- **Two published dataset examples:**
[fecalcanuga](#) & [solidwastekampala](#)
and see [catalogue](#) for all
- **Our newsletter (250 subscribers):**
[buttondown.email/openwashdata](mailto:buttondown.email@openwashdata.org)